

Boost Your Career as a Database Administrator

The demand for adept database administrators will continue to grow in the years to come, opening up innumerable opportunities. A career in this domain comes with both challenges and excellent growth potential.



At a time when 'Big Data' is the buzzword, organisations are looking for novel ways to leverage their colossal data to yield some robust business benefits. Not surprisingly, this has led to immense demand for database administrators (DBAs) to manage the varied databases. Before getting into the nitty-gritty of making a career in database administration, it's important to have a fundamental understanding of the role of a DBA.

A database administrator looks into the installation, backing up, testing and security of the production databases within an IT environment. A DBA also plays an important role in undertaking disaster recovery, performance tuning, instance cloning, or doing a basic back-up routine for the database. Industry leaders say that the job opportunities in this sector are tremendous. As Sai Phanindra T, corporate trainer of SQL School, Hyderabad, puts it, "DBA jobs are evergreen as the actual need for a database administrator comes into play once a given project goes live on the production environment. Though

DBAs are required to assist the project development and testing teams during the life cycle of a project, the most critical aspect of the project implementation, i.e., the maintenance of a project, needs the database administrator."

How important are DBAs for an organisation?

The job of a DBA in an enterprise calls for spontaneity and pro-activeness, as the administrator has to maintain back-ups and pull through data to ensure its accessibility at all times. Vinay Pandey, technical director, Oracle, Koenig Solutions, New Delhi, shares, "This job is vital for mission-critical systems like banks and financial institutions, where one cannot afford any loss of data. A DBA has to devise policies to maintain backups of databases so that there is no hindrance in the functioning of an organisation, in case of any casualty. Here are some of the roles that a DBA performs for an organisation:

- Devising a scalable, steadfast and flexible database that will help in enhancing the growth of the organisation.
- Doing away with the bottlenecks that hamper database